

lies outside my period. Indeed, on my own definition the Vendidad ought likewise to be passed over, since it seems highly probable that this part of it is Sassanian. But an actual Avestan passage can hardly be overlooked. Bartholomae (*AirWb*, 1860—where see literature) is very positive that the institution is known to the Avesta. Under $\chi^v a \acute{e} t v a d a \theta a$ he gives the etymology $\chi^v a \acute{e} t u$, “kin,” and *vadaθa*, “marriage,” despite Justi’s objection. So far I do not see how to question his case, but I would note that the word does not occur in any Avestan text that has a claim to come from the earlier age: I should myself be prepared to put the passages quite late. But when Prof. Bartholomae proceeds (*AirWb*, 1822) to make Queen Hutaosa the sister as well as wife of Vishtaspa, and to find evidence not only in the Pahlavi literature but in *Yt* 15³⁶, I feel the greatest doubt of the inference. In this Yasht passage—which is metrical—Hutaosa “of the many brothers, of the Naotara house,” prays to Vayu that she may be “dear and loved and well received in the house of King Vishtaspa.” Should we not infer that she was about to enter that house for the first time, as a bride? It is stated that both Vishtaspa and his Queen belonged to the Naotara family.¹ That would not make them brother and sister; and Darmesteter further remarks that the Bundahish (31²⁸) excluded

¹ Vishtaspa is called by implication a member of the *Naotairye* in *Yt* 5⁹⁸, a verse passage. The clan pray to Anahita for swift horses, and receive the gift—“Vishtaspa became possessed of the swiftest horses in those lands”—by matrimonial alliance with this house, it might be suggested! Vishtaspa’s name was enough to bring him in where it was a matter of possessing horses (*aspa*).